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The 5 best real-world cases for your info-graphic



1. **MGM Resorts, USA — 2023**

Attack: Social Engineering

Attackers reportedly used social engineering and impersonation to gain access to the company's systems. The cyberattack disrupted hotel operations, digital services, and some customer-facing systems.

How to Prevent: Verify identities before sharing information, use multi-factor authentication, and train employees to recognize suspicious calls.

History and How the Attack Happened

MGM Resorts experienced a major cyberattack in September 2023. Attackers reportedly used social engineering to impersonate an employee and persuade the company's IT help desk to provide access to internal systems.

The attackers reportedly gathered information about an employee from publicly available sources, such as professional networking profiles. They then used this information to make their impersonation more convincing.

After gaining initial access, the attackers compromised company systems and disrupted several digital services. The incident demonstrated how criminals can exploit human trust and weaknesses in identity verification, rather than relying only on technical vulnerabilities.



2. Target Corporation, USA — 2013

Attack: Phishing and Compromised Vendor Credentials

Attackers gained access to Target's network using credentials stolen from a third-party vendor. They then accessed payment systems and stole payment-card information belonging to millions of customers.

Prevention: Secure third-party access, monitor network activity, use multi-factor authentication, and protect payment systems.

History and How the Attack Happened

In 2013, Target Corporation experienced a major cybersecurity breach during the holiday shopping season. Attackers gained access to Target's network using credentials stolen from a third-party company that provided refrigeration and HVAC services to Target stores.

The attackers reportedly obtained the vendor's login credentials through a phishing email. After entering Target's network, they moved into other parts of the system and installed malware on point-of-sale (POS) payment terminals.

The malware collected payment-card data when customers made purchases. This incident demonstrated how attackers can use a less-protected third-party vendor as an entry point to reach a large company's network.



3. Sony Pictures Entertainment, USA — 2014

Attack: Cyber Intrusion and Data Theft

A major cyberattack affected Sony Pictures' computer systems and exposed confidential company information. Internal documents and employee data were leaked, causing significant business and reputational damage.

Prevention: Use strong access controls, encrypt sensitive data, monitor suspicious activity, and prepare an incident-response plan.

History and How the Attack Happened

In November 2014, Sony Pictures Entertainment suffered a major cyberattack. A group calling itself the Guardians of Peace (GOP) claimed responsibility for the attack.

Investigators reported that attackers had gained access to Sony's computer network before launching destructive malware. The malware damaged computer systems, while the attackers stole confidential company information and employee data.

The stolen information included private emails, business documents, employee records and unreleased movies. The attackers later leaked some of this information online, causing serious disruption to the company. The FBI attributed the attack to North Korea.



4. Maersk, International Shipping — 2017

Attack: NotPetya Malware

The NotPetya malware spread through the company's computer systems, disrupting shipping operations and port activities. The attack caused major financial losses and required extensive efforts to restore IT services.

Prevention: Keep systems updated, separate important networks, and maintain tested backup and recovery pla

History and How the Attack Happened

In June 2017, Maersk was affected by the NotPetya malware attack, which spread internationally and disrupted organizations in many countries.

The malware entered Maersk's network through a compromised update to M.E.Doc, a Ukrainian accounting software used for tax reporting. Once inside the network, NotPetya spread between connected computers and damaged systems, making files and applications unavailable.

Because Maersk relied on computer systems to manage shipping bookings, cargo movements, port terminals and business communications, the attack caused major disruption to its global operations. Maersk shut down affected systems to contain the malware and began restoring its IT infrastructure

5. Sony Pictures, USA — 2014

Attack: Destructive malware and data theft

Thousands of computers became unusable, confidential information was stolen, and the company's network was taken offline. Sony estimated approximately US$35 million in costs related to restoring IT and financial systems and investigating the attack.

❖ Detailed case-study content for your slides

You can use one slide per case, with the company photo on the left and the facts on the right.

Case 1 — AIIMS Delhi ransomware attack





Date: 23 November 2022
Location: New Delhi, India

History and background

AIIMS Delhi experienced a ransomware attack that disrupted its e-Hospital system, including patient registration and access to medical records. The specific ransomware family and the precise initial entry method were not publicly confirmed.

Impact and financial loss

- ✧ Hospital registration, billing and digital medical services were disrupted.
- ✧ Staff had to use manual procedures while systems were unavailable.
- ✧ Patient information was at risk.
- ✧ Total financial loss: A verified official total was not publicly established.
- ✧ **Recovery time:** About two weeks for the main server facility to resume service; further restoration continued afterward.

Recovery actions and cost

- ✧ Disconnected and investigated affected systems.
- ✧ Sanitised affected servers and computers.
- ✧ Retrieved data from an unaffected backup server.
- ✧ Worked with government cybersecurity and law-enforcement teams.
- ✧ Recovery cost: No reliable, publicly confirmed official figure for the full recovery cost was identified.

Solutions to prevent recurrence

Maintain offline and regularly tested backups.

Use network segmentation and properly configured firewalls.

Keep operating systems and applications updated.

Apply strict access controls and monitor suspicious activity.

Case 2 — WannaCry attack on the UK's NHS

